In British India, a statistical survey was conducted, in the year 1807 by Dr.Francis Buchanan, Governor-in-Council of *East India Company*. Information were collected regarding topographical account of each district, conditions of the inhabitants, their religion and customs, details of fisheries, mines and forests, farm sizes, vegetables grown, commerce, list of useful plants and seeds. An **Official Statistical System** was established in India by *Col*. Sykes during 1847 with a Department of Statistics in *India House*. The **first Census Report of India** was published in 1848. The second Census Report was published in 1881 and since then Census was conducted every 10 years.

8.2.2 Post-Independence Indian Official Statistical System

After Independence, the need for a statistical system for monitoring socio-economic development of the country was felt by the Government of India. In 1949, Shri.P.C.Mahalanobis was appointed by the Government of India as the Honorary Statistical Advisor to the government. In the same year, he established the Central Statistical Unit. This Unit was renamed, in 1951, as Central Statistical Organization, which coordinated various statistical activities in the country. It also defined and maintained statistical standards in the country.

During the same period, National Income Committee was established in 1949 to estimate the National Income of the country. The Committee recommended the use of sampling methods for collecting information in order to fill the large gaps in the statistical information required for estimation of the National Income. Sample surveys were conducted at national level for this purpose. The first round of National Sample Survey was conducted in October 1950. Later, a separate organization under the government set-up for conducting sample surveys was formed in the name of National Sample Survey Organization.

The Central Statistical Organization and National Sample Survey Organization are now called respectively as Central Statistics Office (CSO) and National Sample Survey Office (NSSO).

The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoS&PI), a ministry with independent charge in the Government of India, was formed on October 15, 1999 with two wings, *viz*., National Statistical Office (NSO) and Programme Implementation.

The Government of India set up a Commission in the year 2000 under the headship of Shri.C.Rangarajan to address the growing statistical needs of the country. Based on the recommendations of the Commission, a permanent and statutory apex body, called **National Statistical Commission** (NSC), was set up in NSO on July 12, 2006. The NSC was formed to evolve policies, priorities and to maintain quality standards in statistical matters.

The NSC is constituted with an eminent statistician or a social-scientist as its Chairperson and four members - one each from the areas of Economic Statistics; Social and Environmental Statistics; Census Operations, Surveys and Statistical Information System; and National Accounts. The Chief Statistician of India is the Secretary of the Commission and the Chief Executive Officer of NITI Aayog of Planning Commission of India is an *ex-officio* member of NSC. The Chief Statistician of India is the Head of National Statistical Office and Secretary of the MoS&PI. NSC, in addition to the above responsibilities, also performs the functions of Governing Council of the NSSO since August 30, 2006.

Presently, the main sections of NSO are NSC, CSO, NSSO and a Computer Center.

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